

0.0.1 The Stilling of Thoughts

1. Thus was heard by me. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindika's Park. At that place the Auspicious One addressed the bhikkhus: "Bhikkhus." "Bhante," those bhikkhus replied to the Auspicious One. The Auspicious One said this:

2. For a bhikkhu devoted to the higher mind, O bhikkhus, he should pay attention to five signs from time to time. What five?

3. Here, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

4. Just as, O bhikkhus, a skilled carpenter or a carpenter's apprentice having used a very tiny peg, would knock out a grosser peg. So too, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu,

whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then, O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should attend to some other sign connected with the wholesome. From his [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

5. If, O bhikkhus, from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering." Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

6. Just as, O bhikkhus, a woman or man, young in years, a youth, fond of adornments, would be troubled, humiliated and disgusted at the corpse of a snake, a corpse of a dog, or a corpse of a human being strung around his or her neck. So too, O bhikkhus, if from that bhikkhu's [withdrawal] from that sign and attention to some other sign connected with the wholesome, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should investigate the danger in those thoughts thus: "These thoughts are indeed unwholesome. These thoughts are indeed blameworthy. These thoughts indeed ripen in suffering." Of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

7. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get

abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

8. Just as, O bhikkhus, a man endowed with eyes wishing not to see forms that have come into his range would close his eyes or would look elsewhere. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu investigating the danger of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should engage in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts. Of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

9. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their

abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

10. Just as, O bhikkhus, it might occur to a man moving quickly thus: “Why am I moving quickly? What if I were to move slowly?” While moving slowly it might occur to him thus: “Why am I moving slowly? What if I were to stand still?” While standing still it might occur to him thus: “Why am I standing still? What if I were to sit down?” While sitting down it might occur to him thus: “Why am I sitting down? What if I were to lie down?” Then he lies down. Thus, O bhikkhus, that man having left behind grosser and grosser postures, would fashion subtler and subtler postures. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu should pay attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts. Of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

11. If, O bhikkhus, for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still

arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

12. Just as, O bhikkhus, a strong man having seized a weaker man by the head, or having seized him by the shoulder, were to forcibly restrain, completely crush, and overwhelm him. So too, O bhikkhus, if for that bhikkhu paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, there still arises evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, then O bhikkhus, that bhikkhu, having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, should forcibly restrain, completely crush down, overwhelm mental states with mental states. Of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming

mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear. From their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi.

13. “From the time, O bhikkhus, for a bhikkhu, whatever sign owing to the attention of which there arises evil, unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion, that bhikkhu [withdrawing] from that sign, attending to some other sign connected with the wholesome, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

14. also of him investigating the danger of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

15. also of him engaging in not being mindful, not attending to those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and

disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

16. also of him paying attention to stilling the thought activities of those thoughts, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned, they disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

17. also of him having clenched the teeth together, having pressed the tongue against the palate, forcibly restraining, completely crushing down, overwhelming mental states with mental states, those evil unwholesome thoughts connected with desire, also connected with hatred, also connected with delusion get abandoned and disappear, and from their abandoning he steadies his mind internally, quietens it, unifies it and stills it in samadhi;

18. this is called, O bhikkhus, a bhikkhu who is the master of the pathways of thoughts. Whichever thoughts he wishes to think, it is just those thoughts that he thinks. Whichever thoughts he does not wish to think, it is just those thoughts that he does not think. He has utterly severed thirsting, disjoined the fetters, and rightly breaking through to conceit, has made an end of suffering.”

19. This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, those bhikkhus rejoiced in the Auspicious One's words.